

Basics of Digital Image Editing - Photoshop Tasks

<> photoshop.md

Basics of Digital Image Editing (Photoshop Tasks)

Objective

This assignment consists of 10 practical tasks designed to help you develop essential Adobe Photoshop skills. Through hands-on exercises, you will learn fundamental image editing techniques including cropping, retouching, color correction, working with layers, making selections and creating composite images.

Skills you will practice:

- Navigating and customizing the Photoshop workspace
- Cropping and resizing images for different outputs (web and print)
- Retouching photos (removing unwanted objects, blemishes, red-eye correction)
- Adjusting colors, exposure, and white balance
- Working with adjustment layers and layer masks
- Using selection tools and refining edges
- Changing object colors realistically
- Creating composite images with realistic shadows
- Using Photoshop's generative AI tools responsibly

Assignment Details

Software Required:

Adobe Photoshop (Version 2023 or later recommended)

Experience Level:

Beginner: No prior Photoshop experience required

Assignment Overview:

- **Total Tasks:** 10
- **Total Points:** 50 points
- **Estimated Time:** 12-15 hours

Submission Requirements:

Each task has specific deliverable requirements that vary based on the exercise. Most tasks require a combination of PSD files, exported images (JPG or PNG) and screenshots. Please carefully read the "Deliverables" section for each task below and include all requested materials in your submission.

Required Practice Images

Download the image pack before starting: Please download the complete image pack from [this link](#).

The downloaded folder contains source images organized by task:

```
Photoshop_Practice_Images/  
├─ Task01_Workspace/  
├─ Task02_CropResize/  
├─ Task03_Retouching/  
├─ Task04_RedEye/  
├─ Task05_ColorCorrection/  
├─ Task06_LayersPractice/  
├─ Task07_Selections/  
├─ Task08_Recolor/  
├─ Task09_Compositing/  
└─ Task10_GenerativeAI/
```

Workflow & File Organization

Step 1: Set up your working folder

The downloaded `Photoshop_Practice_Images` folder already contains all the source images organized by task. You do NOT need to create additional folders.

Simply place the `Photoshop_Practice_Images` folder somewhere on your device:

- **Local storage:** C:\ drive, D:\ drive, or Documents folder
- **Cloud storage:** OneDrive or Google Drive (if you prefer)

You will work on all tasks inside this folder, saving your completed work in the corresponding task subfolder.

Step 2: File naming convention

Each task has specific deliverable requirements (PSD, JPG, PNG, or screenshots) listed in its **Deliverables** section. Follow the naming pattern below for your submissions:

General naming format:

- `TaskXX_Description_FirstName_LastName.extension`
- Example: `Task02_Instagram_John_Smith.jpg` Or `Task04_Portrait_John_Smith.psd`

 **Important:** Not all tasks require the same file types. Always check the "Deliverables" section for each task to see exactly what files you need to submit.

Step 3: Submission

Choose ONE of the following submission methods:

- **Option A:** Zip your entire `Photoshop_YourFirstName_YourLastName` folder and upload to Canvas
- **Option B:** Zip & upload your folder to OneDrive/Google Drive and submit the sharing link to Canvas. Ensure that, the teacher has read access and is able to download the folder

Task 1: Getting Started with Photoshop: Exploring the Workspace (3 Points)

▼  Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn to navigate and customize the Photoshop interface by configuring panels, tools, and workspace themes. A well organized workspace improves efficiency and helps you access tools quickly.

What You'll Learn

- How to show/hide panels
- How to dock and arrange panels
- How to customize the interface theme
- How to save a custom workspace

Background & Resources

Before starting, familiarize yourself with Photoshop's interface:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Photoshop Workspace Basics](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Workspace for Beginners"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Panels** are windows that contain tools and options (Layers, Properties, etc.)
 - **Docking** means attaching panels together or to the interface edges
 - **Workspace** is a saved arrangement of panels and tools

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Open a blank document

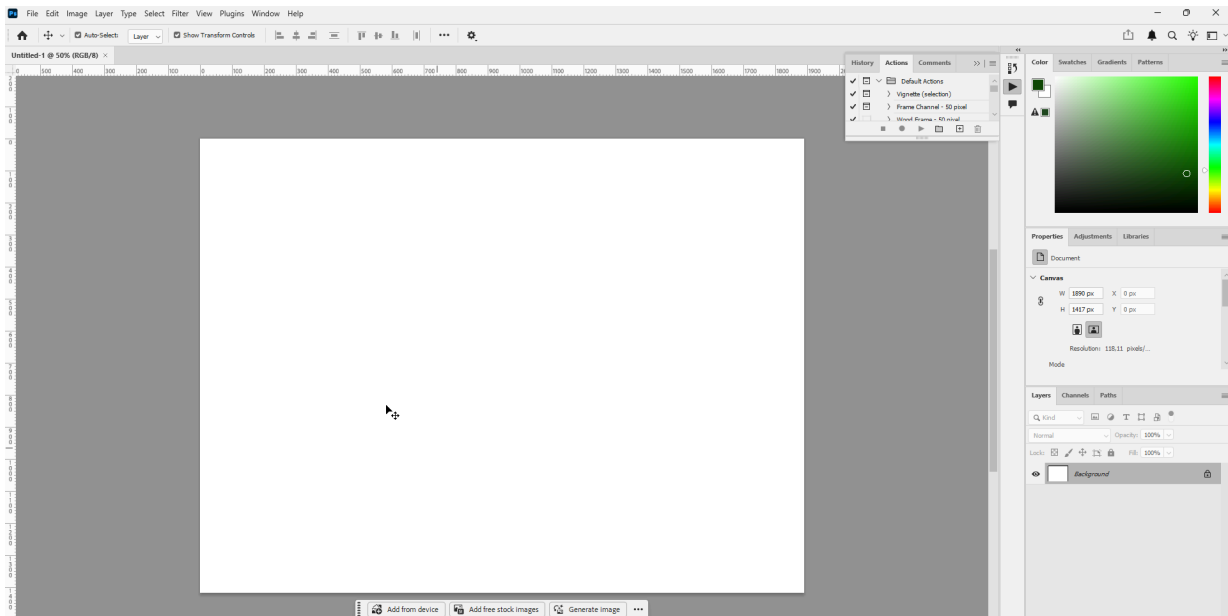
1. Launch Adobe Photoshop
2. Go to **File** → **New**
3. Choose any preset (e.g., "Default Photoshop Size")
4. Click **Create**

Step 2: Enable required panels

1. Go to **Window** menu (top menu bar)
2. Check (enable) the following panels:
 - ✓ Layers
 - ✓ Properties
 - ✓ Actions
 - ✓ Color
3. These panels will now appear in your workspace

Step 3: Configure the Tools panel

1. Locate the **Tools panel** (vertical bar on the left with tool icons)
 - If the Tools panel is not visible, go to **Window → Tools** to enable it



2. Click the **double arrow icon (::)** at the top of the Tools panel
3. Select **2 Column Layout**

Step 4: Dock Actions panel

1. Click and hold the **Actions panel tab** (at the top where it says "Actions")
2. Drag it slowly to the **left side** of the screen, next to the Tools panel
3. As you drag near the docking area, you should see:
 - A **blue highlight** or **thin blue line** indicating where the panel will dock
 - Or a **semi-transparent preview** of the panel position
4. Release the mouse when you see the docking indicator
5. The Actions panel should now be docked next to Tools
 - If it didn't dock, try again by dragging more slowly and positioning it very close to the edge of the Tools panel

Step 5: Dock Color panel

1. Click and hold the **Color panel tab**
2. Drag it slowly **below the Actions panel** on the left side
3. Look for the **blue highlight** or **preview line** showing where it will dock
4. Release when you see the docking indicator

5. Color panel should now be stacked under Actions
 - If it didn't dock properly, drag it again and position it directly under the Actions panel

Step 6: Change interface theme

1. Go to **Edit** → **Preferences** → **Interface**
2. Under **Appearance**, select the **second gray option** (Medium Gray)
3. Click **OK**

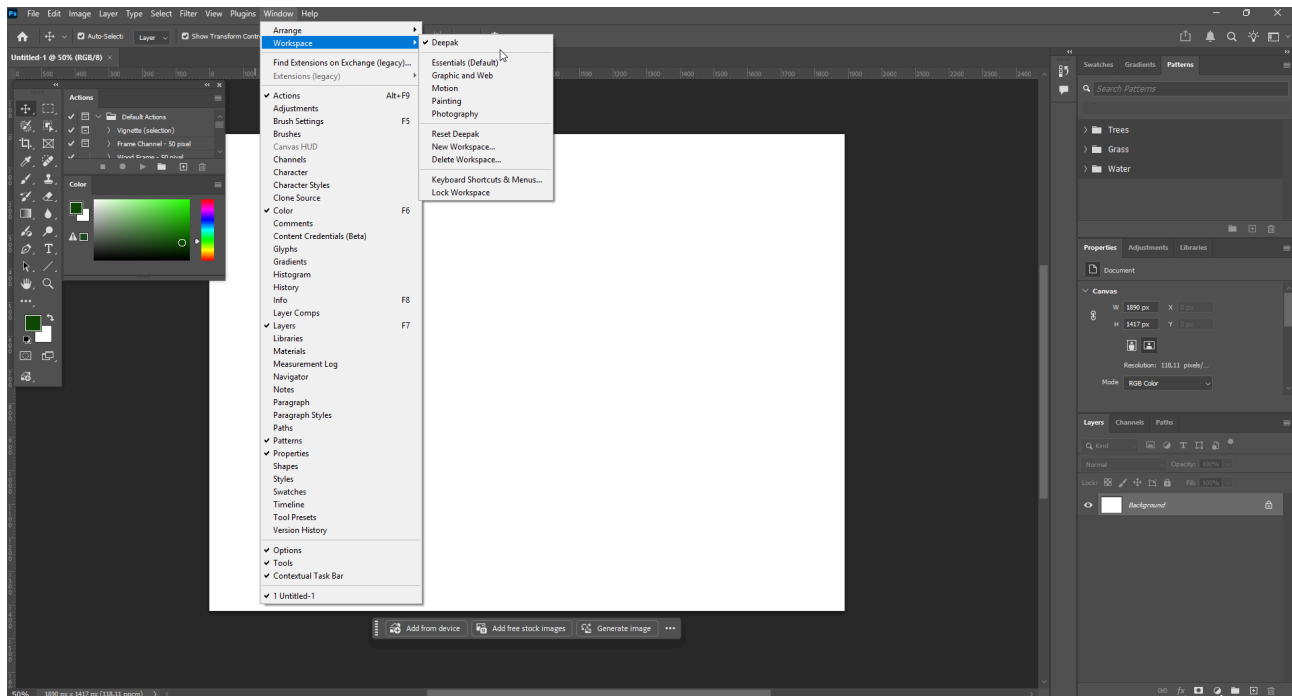
Step 7: Save your workspace

1. Go to **Window** → **Workspace** → **New Workspace...**
2. Name it: YourFull Name Workspace
3. The **Capture** section shows that panel locations will be saved automatically
4. Optionally check any of the following (recommended to check all):
 - ✓ **Keyboard Shortcuts**
 - ✓ **Menus**
 - ✓ **Toolbar**
5. Click **Save**

Step 8: Take a screenshot

1. Make sure your entire Photoshop window is visible, including:
 - All docked panels (Tools, Actions, Color on the left; Layers, Properties on the right)
 - Your workspace name should be visible at the top of the window
 - The gray theme is applied
2. Capture the full Photoshop interface
3. Save as: Task01_Workspace_FirstName_LastName.png

Sample answer for reference:



Deliverables

Save in your **Task01_Workspace** folder:

- Task01_Workspace_FirstName_LastName.png (screenshot showing your customized workspace)

Tips

- 💡 If you make a mistake, go to **Window** → **Workspace** → **Reset Essential** to start over
- 💡 You can access your saved workspace anytime via **Window** → **Workspace** → **Your Workspace Name**
- 💡 Panels can be collapsed by double-clicking their tab name

Grading Criteria (3 pts)

Criterion	Points
All required panels visible (Layers, Properties, Actions, Color)	1
Tools panel in 2-column layout, Actions and Color docked on left	1
Gray theme applied and workspace properly saved	1

Task 2: Crop & Resize for Different Outputs (3 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

Learn how to properly crop, straighten, and resize images for different output formats (social media and print). Understanding resolution and dimensions is essential for producing professional quality images.

What You'll Learn

- How to use the Crop Tool and straighten images
- The difference between pixel dimensions and resolution (PPI)
- How to resize images for web vs. print
- How to export images in appropriate formats

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand these key concepts:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Crop and Straighten Photos](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Crop and Resize for Beginners"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Pixel dimensions** (e.g., 1080×1080) determine the actual size of the image
 - **Resolution (PPI)** = Pixels Per Inch; 72 ppi for web, 300 ppi for print
 - **Aspect ratio** (e.g., 1:1, 16:9) is the proportional relationship between width and height
 - **Instagram posts** use 1080×1080 pixels (1:1 square format)
 - **Print images** require higher resolution (300 ppi) for sharp output

Practice Image

Use: landscape.jpg from the Task02_CropResize folder

Step-by-Step Instructions

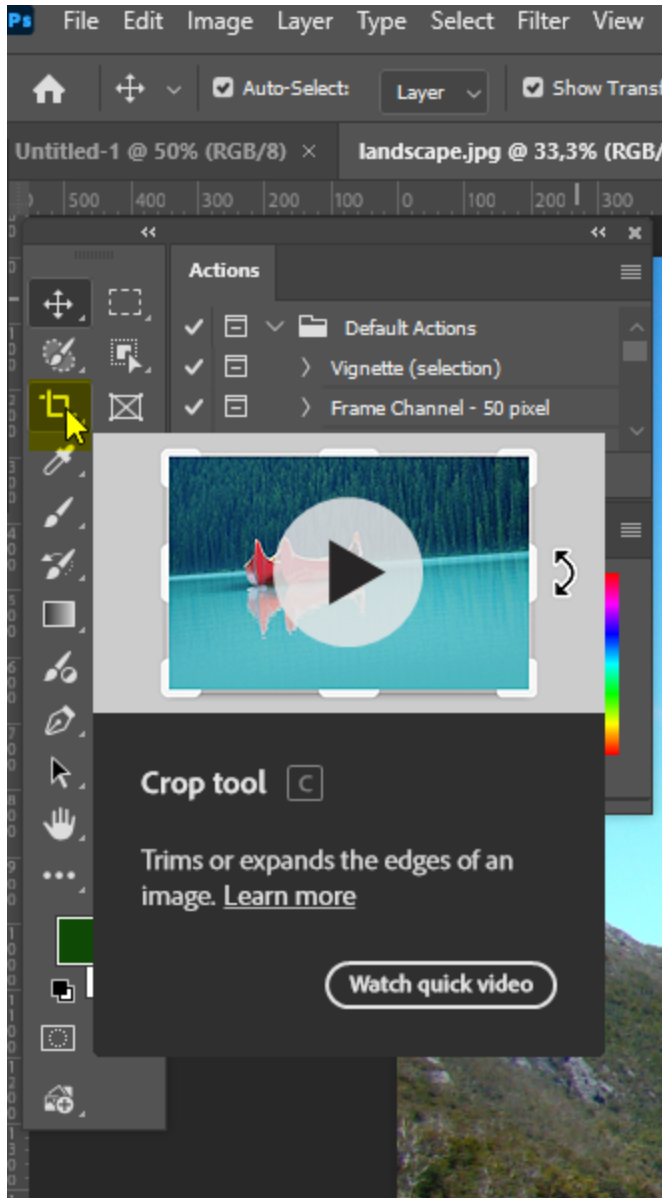
Part A: Create Instagram Version

Step 1: Open the image

1. Go to **File** → **Open**
2. Navigate to **Task02_CropResize** folder
3. Select **landscape.jpg**
4. Click **Open**

Step 2: Select the Crop Tool

1. Click the **Crop Tool** in the Tools panel (or press **C**)
2. The crop overlay will appear on your image



Step 3: Straighten the horizon

The Straighten tool helps fix tilted or crooked images by rotating them to align horizontal or vertical elements (like horizons, buildings, or walls). This is essential for professional looking photos.

1. In the **Options Bar** at the top, click the **Straighten Tool** icon (looks like a level)
2. Click and drag along the horizon line in your image (the horizon can be anywhere in the photo: top, middle, or bottom)
3. Photoshop will automatically rotate the image to level it
4. Press **Enter** to apply

Step 4: Set aspect ratio for Instagram

1. Select the **Crop Tool** again (C)
2. In the **Options Bar**, click the dropdown that says "Ratio"
3. Select **1:1 (Square)**
4. Adjust the crop box to frame your subject nicely
5. Press **Enter** to apply the crop

Step 5: Resize for Instagram

1. Go to **Image** → **Image Size**
2. Make sure **Constrain Proportions** (chain link icon) is locked
3. Set **Width** to 1080 pixels
4. **Height** should automatically set to 1080 pixels
5. Set **Resolution** to 72 Pixels/Inch
6. Make sure **Resample** is set to **Automatic**
7. Click **OK**

Step 6: Export Instagram version

1. Go to **File** → **Export** → **Export As...**
2. In the Export dialog, configure:
 - **Format:** JPG
 - **Quality slider:** 6 or 7 (toward High) for good quality with reasonable file size
3. Click **Export**
4. Save the file
 - **Save location:** Your Task02_CropResize folder
 - **File name:** Task02_Instagram_FirstName_LastName.jpg

Part B: Create Print Version (A4 @ 300 PPI)

Step 7: Undo crops (start fresh)

1. Go to **File** → **Revert** to reload the original image
2. Or press **Ctrl+Z** (Windows) / **Cmd+Z** (Mac) multiple times to undo

Step 8: Straighten again

1. Select **Crop Tool** (C)
2. Use **Straighten Tool** to level the horizon again
3. Press **Enter**

Step 9: Crop for print (no constraint)

1. With **Crop Tool** active, set the dropdown to **Original Ratio**
2. Crop out any unwanted edges or distractions
3. Press **Enter**

Step 10: Resize for A4 print

1. Go to **Image** → **Image Size**
2. Change units to **Centimeters** (from dropdown)
3. Set **Resolution** to 300 Pixels/Inch
4. Set **Width** to 21 cm (A4 width) or **Height** to 29.7 cm (A4 height)
 - **Landscape orientation** (image wider than tall): Set Width to 21 cm (height will adjust automatically)
 - **Portrait orientation** (image taller than wide): Set Height to 29.7 cm (width will adjust automatically)
 - Check the current dimensions in the dialog to determine your image's orientation
 - The other dimension will scale proportionally since Constrain Proportions is locked
5. Make sure **Resample** is checked and set to **Automatic**
6. Click **OK**

Step 11: Export print version

1. Go to **File** → **Export** → **Export As...**
2. In the Export dialog, configure:
 - **Format:** JPG
 - **Quality slider:** 6 or maximum (all the way to High) for best print quality
 - Click **Export**
 - **File name:** Task02_Print_FirstName_LastName.jpg
 - **Save location:** Your Task02_CropResize folder

Deliverables

Save in your **Task02_CropResize** folder:

- Task02_Instagram_FirstName_LastName.jpg (1080×1080 px, 72 ppi)
- Task02_Print_FirstName_LastName.jpg (A4 size, 300 ppi)

Tips

- 💡 **Protect your original:** Keep a backup copy of the original image file in a separate folder before editing. Use **File** → **Revert** to reload the last saved version if you need to start over
- 💡 Instagram accepts up to 1080×1080 for square posts. Larger files will be compressed
- 💡 Use **Straighten Tool** for horizons, building edges, or any vertical/horizontal reference line
- 💡 Higher quality % = larger file size but better image quality

Grading Criteria (3 pts)

Criterion	Points
Instagram version properly cropped (1:1), straightened, and correctly sized (1080×1080, 72 ppi)	1.5
Print version properly sized for A4 at 300 ppi with correct export settings	1.5

Task 3: Object Removal & Retouching (4 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn how to remove unwanted objects from a real urban street photo using Photoshop retouching tools while keeping the image realistic. You will practice professional **photo cleanup techniques** commonly used in advertising, architecture, and urban photography.

What You'll Learn

- How to use the Remove Tool for quick object removal
- Working with the Spot Healing Brush for blemishes and small objects
- Using the Patch Tool for larger area replacement

- Nondestructive retouching with separate layers
- How to maintain realistic textures and backgrounds

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand object removal techniques:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Remove Objects from Photos in Photoshop](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Remove Tool Tutorial"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Remove Tool** uses AI to intelligently remove objects and fill the background
 - **Spot Healing Brush** automatically samples surrounding pixels to blend repairs
 - **Patch Tool** lets you manually select a source area to cover unwanted elements
 - **Nondestructive editing** means working on separate layers to preserve the original

Practice Image

Use: cluttered_scene.jpg from the **Task03_Retouching** folder

This image shows rental bikes cluttering a pavement which is a common urban photography problem where objects block visual space or distract viewers.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Open & Save Working File

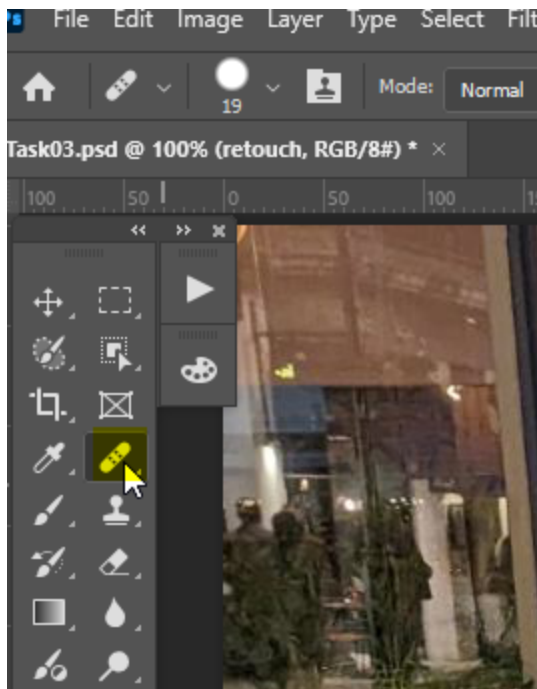
1. Open cluttered_scene.jpg in Photoshop.
2. Save immediately as: Task03_Retouching_FirstName_LastName.psd

Step 2: Create a Retouch Layer

1. Open the **Layers Panel**
2. Click **New Layer**
3. Rename it: retouch
4. Select this layer before editing. All edits must happen on this layer.

Step 3: Select and configure the Remove Tool

1. In the **Tools panel**, locate the **Spot Healing Brush Tool**



- Right-click (or click and hold) on the **Spot Healing Brush Tool** icon
- A menu will appear showing grouped healing tools
- Select **Remove Tool** from the menu (it looks like a brush with sparkles)
- You can also press **Shift+J** repeatedly to cycle through all healing tools until you see "Remove Tool" in the tool name

2. In the **Options Bar** at the top, configure the tool settings:

- Check (✓) **Sample All Layers**, this allows the tool to use information from all visible layers

3. Set your **Brush Size** appropriately:

- Use [key to make brush smaller
- Use] key to make brush larger
- Start with a size slightly larger than the object you want to remove
- You'll see a circular cursor showing the brush size.

Step 4: Remove unwanted objects

1. **Identify objects to remove.** You must remove at least **5 objects** such as:

- Dockless bikes (complete bikes or parts like wheels, handlebars)
- Street signs or poles
- Pedestrians
- Bollards or street obstructions
- Shadows left by removed objects

2. **Zoom in** to 100-150% for better control (Ctrl/Cmd + Plus)
3. **Paint over each object** using the Remove Tool:
 - Simply click and drag to paint over the object you want to remove
 - Work gradually with smaller brush strokes rather than one large stroke
 - Let Photoshop process each removal before moving to the next (you'll see a progress indicator)
 - The AI will intelligently fill the area with matching background texture
4. **Repeat** for each of the 5+ objects you want to remove
5. **Zoom out** (Ctrl/Cmd + 0) periodically to check overall appearance

Step 5: Repair pavement texture with Spot Healing Brush (Optional)

1. After removing objects, you may notice gaps or imperfections in the pavement
2. Select the **Spot Healing Brush Tool** (press J)
3. In the **Options Bar**, set:
 - **Type:** Content-Aware
 - **Sample All Layers:** checked (✓)
4. **Click or brush over** small marks, edges, and minor texture issues
 - Use this tool for areas smaller than your palm when viewing at 100%
5. Adjust brush size as needed with [and] keys

Step 6: Final realism check

1. Toggle the visibility of your retouch layer on/off (click the **eye icon**)
2. Compare before and after versions
3. Ask yourself these questions:
 - Does anything look repeated or cloned?
 - Are shadows believable and consistent with the lighting?
 - Can someone easily tell objects were removed?
4. If you answer "yes" to the last question, refine problem areas: repeat the above steps until you are happy. 😊

Step 9: Export final image

1. Make sure all layers are visible
2. Go to **File** → **Export** → **Export As...**
3. Set **Format** to **JPG**
4. Set **Quality** to high
5. Click **Export**

6. Save as: Task03_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg in your **Task03_Retouching** folder

Step 10: Save your PSD file

1. Go to **File** → **Save As...**
2. Make sure the format is **Photoshop (*.PSD)**
3. Confirm the filename: Task03_Retouching_FirstName_LastName.psd
4. Save in your **Task03_Retouching** folder

Deliverables

Save in your **Task03_Retouching** folder:

- Task03_Retouching_FirstName_LastName.psd
- Task03_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg (final cleaned image)

Tips

💡 **Work nondestructively:** Always retouch on a separate layer so you can undo changes without affecting the original

💡 **Less is more:** Remove only truly distracting elements. Don't over-clean the scene.

💡 If Remove Tool creates artifacts, try using smaller brush strokes or the Spot Healing Brush instead

💡 For objects near complex backgrounds (trees, patterns), the Patch Tool often gives better control

💡 **Zoom in and out** frequently to check your work at different scales

Grading Criteria (4 pts)

Criterion	Points
Retouch layer used	1
Objects removed cleanly	2
Realistic result	1

Task 4: Portrait Fixes (5 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

Learn essential portrait retouching techniques including red-eye removal, teeth whitening, and blemish cleanup. These are fundamental skills for professional portrait editing.

What You'll Learn

- How to remove red-eye effect from flash photography
- Teeth whitening using adjustment layers and masks
- Blemish removal with healing tools
- Natural-looking portrait enhancements

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand portrait retouching:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Retouch and Repair in Photoshop](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Portrait Retouching for Beginners"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Red-eye** is caused by camera flash reflecting off the retina
 - **Adjustment layers with masks** allow targeted, nondestructive edits
 - **Natural retouching** enhances without making the person look artificial
 - Over-whitening teeth can look fake—aim for natural improvement

Practice Image

Use: portrait_redeye.jpg from the **Task04_RedEye** folder

Step-by-Step Instructions

Part A: Remove Red Eye

Step 1: Open the portrait image

1. Go to **File** → **Open**
2. Navigate to **Task04_RedEye** folder
3. Select **portrait_redeye.jpg**
4. Click **Open**

Step 2: Duplicate the background layer

1. Right click the **Background** layer in Layers panel

2. Select **Duplicate Layer**
3. Name it `retouched`
4. Click **OK**

Step 3: Select the Red Eye Tool

1. In the Tools panel, click and hold the **Spot Healing Brush**
2. Select **Red Eye Tool**
3. In the **Options Bar**, set:
 - **Pupil Size:** 50%
 - **Darken Amount:** 50%

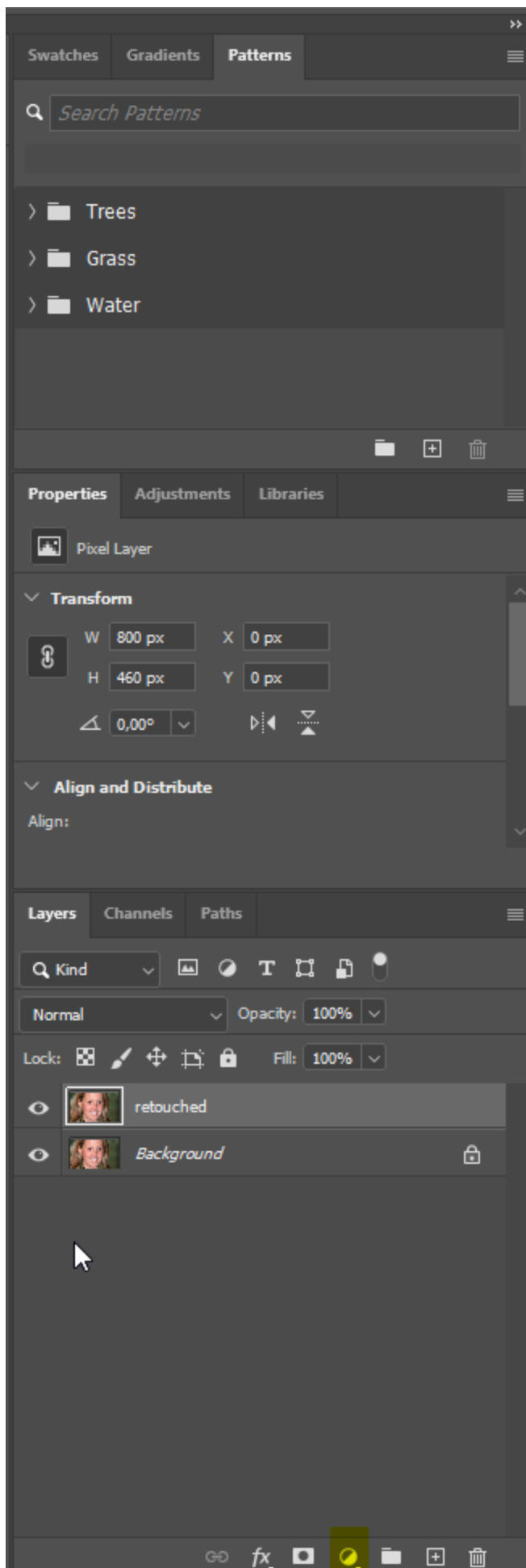
Step 4: Click on red eyes

1. **Zoom in** (Ctrl/Cmd + Plus) to see eyes clearly
2. **Click once** in the center of each red pupil
3. Photoshop will automatically correct the red-eye
4. If result isn't perfect, adjust **Pupil Size** and **Darken Amount** and try again

Part B: Whiten Teeth

Step 5: Create Hue/Saturation adjustment layer

1. In the **Layers panel** (bottom section), look for the **Adjustment Layer** icon at the bottom



- It looks like a **half-filled circle**
- It's usually located at the bottom of the Layers panel, between the layer icons

2. Click on it and select **Hue/Saturation** from the menu

3. The adjustment layer appears above your retouched layer

Step 6: Adjust yellows

1. In the **Properties panel**, locate the row of **colored circles** just below the Preset dropdown
 - You'll see 7 colored circles: a multicolor circle, then red, yellow, green, cyan, blue, and magenta
 - These circles let you target specific color ranges in your image
2. **Click on the YELLOW circle**
 - This tells Photoshop to only adjust yellow tones in the image
3. Now decrease the **Saturation** slider to around **-40 to -50**
 - Drag the slider to the left (toward negative values)
 - This removes yellow tones from teeth, making them appear whiter
4. You might also increase **Lightness** slightly (+5 to +10) if needed

Step 7: Invert the mask

1. In the **Layers panel**, look at the **Hue/Saturation 1** layer
 - You'll see two small thumbnails: the adjustment icon and a white rectangle (the mask)
2. **Click on the white rectangle** (mask thumbnail) to select it
 - A white border will appear around it when selected
3. Now invert the mask using either method:
 - **Method A:** Press **Ctrl+I**
 - **Method B:** In the **Properties panel** (Masks section), click the **Invert** button at the bottom
4. The mask turns **black** (you'll see it change in the Layers panel)
 - **What this does:** Black on a mask means "hide the effect"
 - Right now, the teeth whitening is affecting the ENTIRE image
 - By making the mask black, we hide the whitening effect everywhere
 - **Why we do this:** In the next step, we'll paint white ONLY on the teeth to reveal the whitening just where we want it

Step 8: Paint on teeth

1. Press **B** to select the **Brush Tool**
2. Set **Foreground color to White**
3. In **Options Bar**, set **Opacity** to **50-70%**
4. Set brush to **Soft Round** with appropriate size
5. **Paint over the teeth** to reveal the whitening effect
6. Be careful not to whiten the gums or lips

Part C: Remove Blemishes

Step 9: Select the Spot Healing Brush

1. In the **Layers panel**, click on the **retouched layer** to select it
 - This is important! Blemish removal should happen on this layer, NOT on the mask
2. Press **J** to select **Spot Healing Brush Tool**
3. In **Options Bar**, set:
 - **Type:** Content-Aware
 - **Size:** Slightly larger than the blemish

Step 10: Remove 3-5 blemishes

1. **Click or brush over** any skin blemishes, spots, or minor imperfections
2. Remove at least **3-5 blemishes**
3. Use short clicks rather than long strokes for better results
4. Adjust brush size as needed

Step 11: Check your work

1. **Zoom out** to normal view
2. Toggle layer visibility (click eye icon) to compare before/after
3. Make sure edits look natural but not over processed

Step 12: Export images

Export the after image:

1. Turn all layers back on to show final retouching
2. **File → Export → Export As**
3. Format: **JPG**, Quality: **8-9** (high quality)

4. Name: Task04_After_FirstName_LastName.jpg

Save PSD file:

1. File → Save As
2. Format: **Photoshop (*.PSD)**
3. Name: Task04_Portrait_FirstName_LastName.psd

Deliverables

Save in your **Task04_RedEye** folder:

- Task04_After_FirstName_LastName.jpg
- Task04_Portrait_FirstName_LastName.psd

Tips

- 💡 For red-eye, one click is usually enough. Don't click repeatedly
- 💡 When whitening teeth, use **low opacity** (50-70%) for natural results
- 💡 For blemishes, use a brush slightly **larger than the blemish** itself

Grading Criteria (5 pts)

Criterion	Points
Red-eye completely removed from both eyes	1
Teeth whitened naturally (not over-processed or affecting gums)	2
At least 3-5 blemishes removed cleanly with natural skin texture preserved	2

Task 5: Color Correction (5 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn professional color correction techniques using Camera Raw Filter. You'll fix exposure problems, adjust white balance, and enhance colors while working nondestructively with Smart Objects.

What You'll Learn

- Converting layers to Smart Objects for nondestructive editing
- Using Camera Raw Filter for comprehensive color adjustments
- Understanding exposure, highlights, shadows, and white balance
- Working with Tone Curves for advanced tonal control

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand color correction:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Adjust Color and Tone in Camera Raw](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Camera Raw Color Correction"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Smart Objects** preserve original data and allow re-editable filters
 - **White Balance** corrects color temperature (warm/cool tones)
 - **Exposure** controls overall brightness
 - **Highlights** affect bright areas, **Shadows** affect dark areas
 - **Tone Curve** provides precise control over tonal ranges

Practice Image

Use: `poorly_exposed.jpg` from the **Task05_ColorCorrection** folder

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Open the image

1. Go to **File** → **Open**
2. Navigate to **Task05_ColorCorrection** folder
3. Select `poorly_exposed.jpg`
4. Click **Open**

Step 2: Convert to Smart Object

1. Right click the layer in the **Layers panel**
2. Select **Convert to Smart Object**
3. The layer icon changes to show a small page icon
4. This allows you to reedit the Camera Raw adjustments later

Step 3: Open Camera Raw Filter

1. Go to **Filter** → **Camera Raw Filter**
2. The Camera Raw workspace opens
3. On the right side, you'll see various adjustment panels

Step 4: Analyze the Image First

Before making any adjustments, **analyze what's wrong**:

Look at the image and histogram:

- The image looks **very dark** (underexposed)
- Colors appear **too blue** (cool color cast)
- The **histogram** data is mostly pushed to the **left** (dark side)

What this means: 👉 The image is underexposed and has incorrect white balance. You need to fix **color first**, then **brightness**.

Step 5: Adjust White Balance (Fix Color Cast First)

⚠️ **Important:** Always correct color temperature BEFORE adjusting brightness.

5A. Evaluate the color cast

In the **Basic** panel, look at the **Temperature** and **Tint** sliders.

Ask yourself:

- Does the scene look too **blue or cold**?
- Do neutral areas (fog, roads, walls) look unnatural?

In this image: ✅ The scene has a **strong blue color cast** (too cool)

5B. Adjust Temperature slider

1. Locate the **Temperature** slider in the Basic panel
2. **Move the slider RIGHT** (toward warmer/yellow tones)
 - This reduces the excessive blue tones
3. **Suggested range:** Temperature: **+10 to +30**
4. Watch the image now.

Your goal:

-  Fog and landscape look **natural**
-  Night mood remains **realistic**
-  Image should **NOT** look orange or artificial

5C. Adjust Tint (if needed)

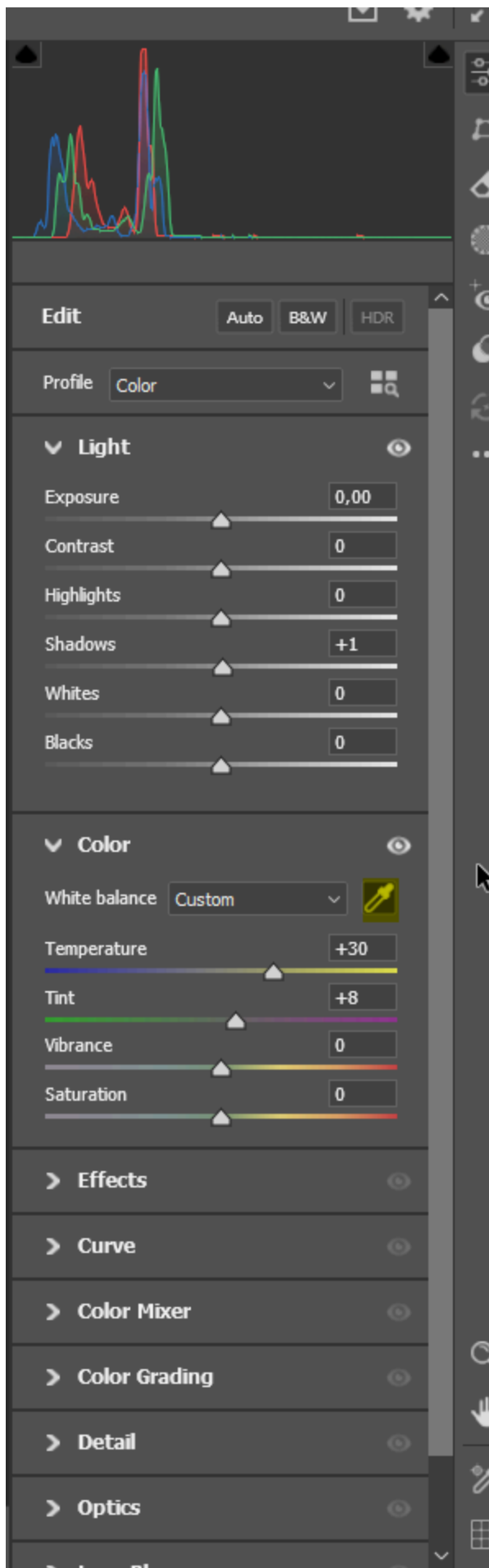
Only adjust Tint if you notice a **green or magenta** color shift.

1. Move **Tint** slider left (green) or right (magenta) slightly
2. Usually requires only small adjustments: ± 5
3. Most images don't need tint adjustment

5D. Quick Auto Method (Alternative)

Instead of manual adjustment, you can let Photoshop auto-correct:

1. **Locate the White Balance Tool:**



- Look in the **Color** section on the **right panel** of the Camera Raw window
 - Find the "**White balance**" dropdown (it may say "Custom")
 - Look for the **eyedropper icon** next to the White balance dropdown or near the Temperature/Tint sliders
 - Hover over the eyedropper to confirm the tooltip says "**White Balance Tool**"
2. **Click** the White Balance Tool to activate it (your cursor will change to an eyedropper)
 3. **Click on something in the image** that should be **neutral gray or white**
 - Good examples: fog, concrete road, white wall, clouds, asphalt, gray pavement
 - Avoid clicking on colored objects (trees, lights, sky)
 4. Camera Raw automatically adjusts the **Temperature** and **Tint** sliders to balance the color
 5. If you don't like the result, press **Ctrl+Z** (Windows) or **Cmd+Z** (Mac) to undo and try clicking a different neutral area

Step 6: Correct Exposure (Overall Brightness)

Now that colors are corrected, fix the overall brightness.

1. In the **Light* panel, locate the **Exposure** slider
2. **Slowly move the slider RIGHT** (toward positive values)
3. **Suggested range:** Exposure: **+0.8 to +1.5**

Watch the changes carefully:

-  Trees become visible
-  House details appear
-  Scene should **still look like nighttime**

 **Do NOT turn night into daytime!** Keep the mood realistic.

Check the histogram:

- The histogram should move toward the **center** (not stuck on the left anymore)
- You should see better distribution across tonal ranges

Step 7: Recover Highlights and Shadows

The Exposure slider brightened everything equally. Now recover lost detail in bright and dark areas.

7A. Lift Shadows (reveal dark areas)

1. Locate the **Shadows** slider under Light.
2. Move **RIGHT** (toward positive values): **+40 to +60**

What you should now see:

- ☒ Tree shapes and branches
- ☒ Ground detail and texture
- ☒ Fog texture and layers

7B. Reduce Highlights (protect bright areas)

1. Locate the **Highlights** slider
2. Move **LEFT** (toward negative values): **-10 to -30**

What this does:

- ☒ Prevents blown-out bright lights
- ☒ Recovers detail in sky or light sources
- ☒ Stops glowing

Step 8: Set Whites and Blacks (Add Depth and Contrast)

This step fine tunes the brightest and darkest points for better contrast.

8A. Adjust Whites

1. Locate the **Whites** slider
2. Move **RIGHT** (positive): **+10 to +25**
 - This brightens the brightest parts of the image

8B. Adjust Blacks

1. Locate the **Blacks** slider
2. Move **LEFT** (negative): **-10 to -25**
 - This deepens the darkest shadows

Result:

- ☒ Better overall contrast
- ☒ More professional, polished look
- ☒ Image gains depth and dimension

Step 9: Enhance Colors Naturally

After fixing exposure, colors may still look dull or flat. Enhance them carefully.

9A. Use Vibrance (recommended)

1. Locate the **Vibrance** slider under Color.
2. Move **RIGHT**: +10 to +20

Why Vibrance?

- ☒ Enhances weak colors without over saturating already vibrant colors
- ☒ Safe and natural looking
- ☒ Protects skin tones

9B. Use Saturation sparingly

1. Locate the **Saturation** slider
2. Keep adjustments minimal: **0 to +5 only**

 **Warning:** Too much saturation makes images look fake and destroys realism

Step 10: Fine-Tune with Tone Curve (Optional)

For more advanced tonal control, use the Tone Curve.

10A. Open Tone Curve panel

1. In the **right panel** of Camera Raw, click the **Curve** icon (second icon from the top)
 - It looks like a small curve graph icon
2. The Tone Curve panel opens
3. You'll see:
 - A **diagonal line** on a grid with a **histogram** in the background
 - Four sliders below: **Highlights, Lights, Darks, Shadows**

10B. Adjust using the curve OR sliders

Method 1: Using the Curve (More Control)

1. Click and drag directly on the diagonal line to create adjustment points:
 - **For highlights:** Click near the **top-right** area of the line and drag **UP** slightly (+5 to +15)
 - **For shadows:** Click near the **bottom-left** area of the line and drag **DOWN** slightly (-5 to -15)
2. This creates a gentle **S-curve** that adds contrast

Method 2: Using the Sliders (Easier)

1. Adjust the sliders below the curve:
 - **Highlights:** Move right (+5 to +15) to brighten bright areas
 - **Shadows:** Move left (-5 to -15) to deepen dark areas
 - **Lights and Darks:** Fine-tune middle tones if needed

Benefits:

-  Adds sophisticated contrast
-  Improves tonal separation without losing detail
-  Makes the image "pop"

 **Keep movements small** dramatic adjustments look unnatural. Subtle changes are best.

Step 11: Review Before Applying

Before applying your changes, review the overall result.

1. Press **P** on your keyboard to toggle **Before/After preview**
2. Check the following:
 -  Image is brighter but still looks **natural**
 -  **Night atmosphere** is preserved (not turned into daytime)
 -  No extreme or artificial colors
 -  Histogram shows good distribution across the middle range
3. If needed, go back and refine any adjustments

Key principle:  Color correction is **not** about making the image as bright as possible. The goal is to **reveal detail while preserving the original mood** of the scene.

Step 12: Apply Changes

1. Click **OK** button at the bottom right
2. Camera Raw Filter closes and returns you to Photoshop
3. Look in the **Layers panel**. Camera Raw now appears as a **Smart Filter** under your Smart Object layer

✓ **Your edits remain fully editable!** Double click "Camera Raw Filter" anytime to reopen and adjust.

Step 13: Screenshot Layers Panel

Document your work by capturing the Layers panel.

1. Make sure the **Layers panel** is visible and shows:
 - Your Smart Object layer
 - The Camera Raw Filter attached below it
2. **Take a screenshot:**
 - **Windows:** Press **Windows Key + Shift + S**, then drag to select the Layers panel area
 - **Mac:** Press **Cmd + Shift + 4**, then drag to select the Layers panel area
3. Save as: `Task05_Layers_FirstName_LastName.png` in your Task05_ColorCorrection folder

Step 14: Save and export

Save PSD file:

1. **File → Save As**
2. Format: **Photoshop (*.PSD)**
3. Name: `Task05_ColorCorrection_FirstName_LastName.psd`
4. Save in your Task05_ColorCorrection folder

Export JPG image:

1. **File → Export → Export As**
2. Format: **JPG**
3. Quality: **90%** (high quality)
4. Name: `Task05_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg`
5. Save in your Task05_ColorCorrection folder

Deliverables

1.  Task05_ColorCorrection_FirstName_LastName.psd (PSD file with Smart Object and Camera Raw filter)
2.  Task05_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg (corrected JPG image)
3.  Task05_Layers_FirstName_LastName.png (screenshot showing Layers panel with Smart Object and filter)

Tips

-  **Re-edit anytime:** Double-click the "Camera Raw Filter" text in the Layers panel to reopen and modify your adjustments
-  **Check for clipping:** Hold **Alt/Option** while adjusting Whites/Blacks sliders to see which areas are losing detail
-  **Vibrance > Saturation:** Use **Vibrance** instead of Saturation for more natural color enhancement that protects skin tones
-  **Histogram check:** A well-balanced histogram should span across the range without severe clipping on either end
-  **Toggle preview:** Press **P** in Camera Raw to quickly compare Before/After
-  **Work in order:** Always fix white balance **FIRST**, then exposure, then fine-tune with other sliders
-  **Less is more:** Don't over process, subtle and realistic adjustments look more professional than dramatic changes
-  **Preserve the mood:** Remember that the goal is revealing detail, not changing the atmosphere of the scene

Grading Criteria (5 pts)

Criterion	Points
Image properly converted to Smart Object and Camera Raw filter applied	2
Quality of corrections: proper white balance, exposure, and tonal adjustments with natural-looking results	2
All files properly exported with correct naming and screenshot included	1

Task 6: Layers & Masks (5 Points)

▼  Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn the fundamental concepts of adjustment layers and layer masks to create targeted, nondestructive edits. You'll learn to selectively apply effects to specific parts of an image.

What You'll Learn

- Creating and using adjustment layers (Curves, Hue/Saturation)
- Masking adjustments to affect only specific areas
- Adding and styling text layers
- Organizing layers with groups and proper naming

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand layers and masks:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Layers Basics](#) and [Layer Masks](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Adjustment Layers and Masks Tutorial"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Adjustment layers** apply effects without permanently changing pixels
 - **Layer masks** control where adjustments are visible (black hides, white reveals)
 - **Curves** adjust tonal ranges and contrast
 - **Hue/Saturation** changes colors and color intensity
 - **Layer groups** organize complex projects

Practice Image

Use: scene_composite.jpg from the Task06_LayersPractice folder

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Open the image

1. Go to **File** → **Open**
2. Navigate to **Task06_LayersPractice** folder

3. Select `scene_composite.jpg`
4. Click **Open**

Part A: Add Curves Adjustment

Step 2: Create Curves adjustment layer

1. In the **Layers panel**, click the **Adjustment Layer** icon (half-filled circle at bottom)
2. Select **Curves**
3. The Curves adjustment layer appears above your image
4. The **Properties panel** opens showing the curve

Step 3: Adjust the curve to add contrast

1. Look at the **Curves** graph in the Properties panel
 - You'll see a **diagonal line** going from bottom left to top right
 - Bottom left controls **shadows** (dark areas)
 - Middle controls **midtones**
 - Top right controls **highlights** (bright areas)
2. **Brighten the midtones:**
 - Click on the **center** of the diagonal line
 - Drag **upward** slightly (just a little bit)
 - This makes the middle tones brighter
3. **Add contrast (optional):**
 - Click on the **bottom-left area** of the line (about 1/4 from the bottom)
 - Drag **down** very slightly to deepen shadows
 - This creates more contrast between light and dark areas
4. **Your curve should look like a very gentle "S" shape** when you're done
 - Keep adjustments **subtle**

Step 4: Apply the Curves adjustment to only one area (using a mask)

Right now, the Curves adjustment is affecting your **entire image**. Let's make it affect only a **specific area** you choose.

1. **Find the mask in the Layers panel:**

- Look at your **Curves adjustment layer** in the Layers panel
- You'll see **two small thumbnails**:
 - Left thumbnail = the Curves icon
 - Right thumbnail = a **white rectangle** (this is the mask)
- **Click on the white rectangle** to select it
- A white border will appear around it when it's selected

2. Hide the adjustment everywhere (invert the mask to black):

- Press **Ctrl+I** (Windows) or **Cmd+I** (Mac)
- The white rectangle turns **black**
- **What just happened?** The brightening effect is now **completely hidden**
- You won't see any changes to your image anymore
- **Why?** Black on a mask means "hide the effect"

3. Prepare to paint white to reveal the effect:

- Press **B** to select the **Brush Tool**
- Look at the bottom of the **Tools panel** for two overlapping squares (these show your colors)
- Make sure **White** is on top (this is your foreground color)
- If black is on top, press **X** to swap the colors

4. Set brush options:

- In the **Options Bar** at the top, find **Opacity**
- Set it to **70-80%** (this makes the effect gradual and natural)
- Set brush to **Soft Round**
- Adjust the size of the brush as required

5. Paint to reveal the brightening effect:

- **Click and drag** to paint over a specific area you want to brighten
- **Suggested areas for this image**:
 - The **cat's face** (especially the eyes) to make it stand out
 - The **fabric surface** in the foreground
- As you paint, the brightening effect will **gradually appear** only where you paint
- **Tip**: Paint slowly and build up the effect.

Part B: Add Hue/Saturation Adjustment

Step 5: Create Hue/Saturation adjustment layer

1. Click the **Adjustment Layer** icon again
2. Select **Hue/Saturation**
3. New adjustment layer appears above Curves

Step 6: Adjust colors

1. In the **Properties panel**:
 - Move **Hue** slider to shift all colors (try +10 to +15)
 - OR increase **Saturation** (+15 to +25) to make colors more vibrant
 - OR choose a specific color from the dropdown (e.g., Reds, Blues) and adjust only that color
2. Experiment to create an interesting color effect

Step 7: Mask Hue/Saturation to a different area

1. Select the **mask thumbnail** on the Hue/Saturation layer
2. Press **Ctrl+I / Cmd+I** to invert to black
3. With **Brush Tool (B)** and **white foreground color**
4. Set **Opacity** to **60-70%**
5. Paint on a **different area** than you painted before
 - **Example for this image:** If you brightened the cat's face with Curves, now enhance the fabric background with Hue/Saturation to add warmth or color to those areas

Part C: Add Text Overlay

Step 8: Create text layer

1. Press **T** to select the **Horizontal Type Tool**
2. Click anywhere on the image
3. Type a caption or title (e.g., location name, date, or creative caption)

Step 9: Style the text

1. Select all the text (**Ctrl+A / Cmd+A** while typing)
2. In the **Options Bar** at top:
 - Choose a **font** (clean fonts like Arial, Helvetica work well)

- Set **font size** (large enough to read easily)
- Choose **color** by clicking the color box
- 3. Press **Ctrl+Enter** (Windows) or **Cmd+Return** (Mac) to finalize

Step 10: Position and enhance text

1. Press **V** for Move Tool
2. **Drag** text to a good position (avoid busy areas of the image)
3. Optional: Add a drop shadow for readability:
 - Right click the text layer
 - Choose **Blending Options**
 - Check **Drop Shadow**
 - Adjust settings (Distance: 5, Size: 10)
 - Click **OK**

Part D: Organize Layers

Step 11: Rename layers

1. Double click each layer name
2. Rename descriptively:
 - Curves - Cat Face Brighten (or whatever area you brightened)
 - Hue/Sat - Background Enhance (or whatever area you colored)
 - Title Text

Step 12: Create a layer group

Grouping layers helps you stay organized, especially when working with multiple adjustments.

1. **Select all adjustment layers:**
 - In the **Layers panel**, click on your first adjustment layer (e.g., Curves)
 - Hold **Shift** and click on the last adjustment layer (e.g., Hue/Saturation)
 - All adjustment layers between them should now be highlighted in blue
2. **Create the group:**
 - Press **Ctrl+G** (Windows) or **Cmd+G** (Mac)
 - **What happens:** A **folder icon** appears in the Layers panel

- The folder contains all your selected layers inside it
- You'll see a small arrow (▶) next to the folder

3. Rename the group:

- Double click on the text "Group 1" (the folder name)
- Type: **Adjustments**
- Press **Enter**

4. Using the group:

- Click the **arrow** (▶) to collapse the folder and hide the layers inside
- Click again (▼) to expand and see all layers
- This keeps your workspace clean and organized!

Step 13: Save and export

1. File → Save As

- Format: **Photoshop (*.PSD)**
- Name: `Task06_LayersPractice_FirstName_LastName.psd`

2. File → Export → Export As

- Format: **JPG**, Quality: **90%**
- Name: `Task06_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg`

Deliverables

Save in your **Task06_LayersPractice** folder:

- `Task06_LayersPractice_FirstName_LastName.psd` (with all adjustment layers, masks, text, and groups)
- `Task06_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg` (final composed image with text)

Tips

- 💡 **Black conceals, white reveals** on masks—remember this rule!
- 💡 Use soft brushes with **60-80% opacity** for smooth mask transitions
- 💡 Press **X** to swap foreground/background colors while painting masks
- 💡 Hold **Alt/Option** and click a mask thumbnail to view the mask itself
- 💡 Name layers as you create them—it saves time in complex projects
- 💡 Use **Shift+Click** on multiple layers to select and group them together

Grading Criteria (5 pts)

Criterion	Points
Both Curves and Hue/Saturation adjustment layers properly applied	2
Masks accurately painted to affect only specific areas (not the entire image)	2
Text added and layers properly organized with descriptive names and groups	1

Task 7: Selection & Masking (5 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn precise selection techniques and the Select and Mask workspace to create clean cutouts with refined fur edges. This is essential for compositing and isolating subjects from backgrounds.

What You'll Learn

- Using selection tools (Object Selection, Quick Selection) on animals with fur
- Refining complex fur edges with Select and Mask workspace
- Removing color contamination from green/colored backgrounds
- Creating clean edges without halos or fringing
- Outputting selections as transparent PNG files

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand selections and masking:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Make Selections in Photoshop](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Select and Mask Fur Tutorial"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Selection** defines an isolated area of an image
 - **Select and Mask** workspace provides precise edge refinement for complex edges like fur
 - **Halos** are unwanted edge colors from the original background (green fringing from grass)

- **Color Decontamination** removes background color that bleeds into semi-transparent fur edges
- **Transparent PNG** preserves the cutout with no background
- **Fur refinement** requires larger radius values and careful edge brushing

Practice Image

Use: `pets_on_grass.jpg` from the **Task07_Selections** folder

About this image: This photo shows a dog and cat lying together on green foliage. You'll select **one of the animals** (choose either the dog or the cat) and isolate it from the background. The complex fur textures and green background make this perfect for learning professional selection techniques.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Open the image

1. Go to **File** → **Open**
2. Navigate to **Task07_Selections** folder
3. Select `pets_on_grass.jpg`
4. Click **Open**

Step 2: Select your subject (dog OR cat)

1. **Decide which animal to select:** Choose either the dog or the cat
 - The **dog** has fluffy white/golden fur (softer, more varied edges)
 - The **cat** has striped tabby fur (more defined patterns)
2. In the **Tools panel**, select **Object Selection Tool** (or press **W**)
3. In the **Options Bar**, choose **Lasso** mode
4. **Draw a TIGHT selection** around your chosen animal **ONLY**
 - **IMPORTANT:** Draw your lasso **close** to only the animal you want
 - **Stay away** from the other animal - don't include it in your lasso area
 - If selecting the **dog**: Draw tightly around just the dog's outline, avoid the cat completely
 - If selecting the **cat**: Draw tightly around just the cat's outline, avoid the dog completely

5. Release the mouse. Photoshop's AI will automatically detect and select your chosen animal

6. If BOTH animals get selected (common problem):

- Press **Ctrl+D** (Windows) or **Cmd+D** (Mac) to deselect
- Try again with a **TIGHTER** lasso selection around only your chosen animal
- **Alternative method:** Use **Quick Selection Tool** instead:
 - Press **W** repeatedly to switch to Quick Selection Tool (icon looks like a brush with a dotted line)
 - Set brush size to about **30-50px** in the Options Bar
 - **Click and drag ONLY** on the animal you want to select
 - If it accidentally selects the other animal too, hold **Alt** (Windows) or **Option** (Mac) and paint over the unwanted animal to remove it from the selection

7. **Verify:** Only ONE animal should have marching ants around it before continuing

Step 3: Open Select and Mask workspace

1. With the selection active (marching ants visible)
2. Click **Select and Mask** button in the Options Bar
3. Or go to **Select → Select and Mask**
4. The Select and Mask workspace opens

Step 4: Choose a view mode

1. In the **Properties panel** on the right, find **View Mode**
2. Click the dropdown and select **On Black** or **On White**
 - This helps you see edge problems clearly
3. You can press **F** to cycle through different view modes

Step 5: Refine the selection

1. Select the **Refine Edge Brush Tool** (second icon in left toolbar, or press **R**)
2. Set brush size to around **30-50 px**
3. **Paint along the fur edges** where the selection is imperfect:
 - **All around the animal's fur.** Especially where it's fluffy or wispy.
 - Areas where **green background shows through the fur**
4. Photoshop will intelligently refine these fur edges
5. **For this image:** Take extra time on the fur. It's complex and will benefit from careful refinement

Step 6: Adjust edge detection settings

1. In the **Properties** panel, find **Edge Detection**
2. Check **Smart Radius**
3. Adjust **Radius** slider:
 - For the **dog's fluffy fur**: Use **10-15 px** (larger radius for soft, wispy edges)
 - For the **cat's fur**: Use **8-12 px** (slightly smaller for defined edges)
4. Watch the preview update in realtime, the fur should look more natural

Step 7: Clean up edges

1. Under **Global Refinements** in Properties:
 - **Smooth**: 1-3 (smooths jagged edges)
 - **Feather**: 0.5-1 px (softens edge slightly)
 - **Contrast**: 0-10% (sharpens edge transition)
 - **Shift Edge**: -1 to -5% (contracts selection to remove halos)
2. Adjust **Shift Edge** carefully, negative values shrink the selection inward, which removes background color fringe from the edges.

Step 8: Decontaminate colors (remove halos)

 **Critical for this image:** The green grass background will create green color fringing on the fur edges. This step removes it.

1. Under **Output Settings** at bottom of Properties
2. Check **Decontaminate Colors**
3. Move the **Amount** slider to around **60-80%**
 - Start at **60%** and increase if you still see green tinting on fur edges
 - **For this image**: You'll likely need closer to **70-80%** because of the strong green background
4. Watch the fur edges, the green tint should disappear
5. This is **essential** without it, your cutout will have an obvious green glow

Step 9: Set output options

1. Still in **Output Settings**
2. **Output To**: Select **New Layer with Layer Mask**
3. This creates a new layer with a mask applied
4. Click **OK** to apply

Step 10: Check the result

1. You're back in the main Photoshop interface
2. A new layer with mask appears in Layers panel
3. **Zoom in** (Ctrl/Cmd + Plus) to inspect fur edges closely
4. Look for problems:
 - **Green halos or fringing** around the fur (especially white/light fur areas)
 - Missing parts of the **ears, whiskers, or wispy fur**
 - Jagged or unnatural edges
 - Areas where the **other animal** accidentally got included
5. **For this image:** Pay special attention to white/light fur areas. They show green contamination most clearly.

Step 11: Fix remaining issues (if needed)

1. Click the **mask thumbnail** (black/white icon) on the layer
2. Press **B** for Brush Tool
3. Paint with **white** to reveal more, **black** to hide
4. Use a soft brush at **100% opacity** for clean edges

Step 12: Export as transparent PNG

1. **Hide or delete** the original background layer (turn off eye icon)
2. You should see a checkerboard pattern (transparency) behind your subject
3. Go to **File → Export → Export As**
4. Set **Format** to **PNG**
5. Make sure **Transparency** is checked
6. Name: Task07_Cutout_FirstName_LastName.png
7. Click **Export**

Step 14: Save PSD

1. **File → Save As**
2. Format: **Photoshop (*.PSD)**
3. Name: Task07_Selection_FirstName_LastName.psd

Deliverables

Save in your **Task07_Selections** folder:

- Task07_Cutout_FirstName_LastName.png (transparent PNG with your selected animal isolated, dog or cat only)

- Task07_Selection_FirstName_LastName.psd (working file)

Tips

- 💡 Use **Shift Edge** with negative values (-2 to -5%) to eliminate green halos around fur
- 💡 **Decontaminate Colors at 70-80%** is essential for this image. The green background requires aggressive decontamination.
- 💡 Press **F** in Select and Mask to cycle view modes. Try **On White** to see green fringing clearly
- 💡 For fur, use larger **Radius** values (10-15 px) in Edge Detection to capture wispy edges
- 💡 **Refine Edge Brush** on ALL fur areas. don't skip the ears, they're the most challenging part
- 💡 Zoom in to **200-300%** to check white fur areas. Green contamination shows up most there
- 💡 If you accidentally select both animals, undo and try again. Select only **ONE** animal

Grading Criteria (5 pts)

Criterion	Points
Clean fur edges without green halos, fringing, or background contamination	2
Only one animal isolated (not both) with accurate edge refinement	1
Layer mask properly applied and visible	1
Transparent PNG correctly exported with selected subject cleanly isolated	1

Task 8: Recolor Object (5 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn how to change an object's color realistically using selection tools and adjustment layers. This technique is essential for product photography, creative edits, and design work where you need to explore different color variations without permanently altering the original image.

What You'll Learn

- Selecting specific objects with precision selection tools
- Using Hue/Saturation adjustment layers for color changes
- Understanding colorize vs. hue shift techniques
- Refining layer masks for realistic color application
- Creating natural-looking recolored objects

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand color manipulation:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Adjust Hue and Saturation](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Recolor Object Tutorial"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Hue** shifts colors around the color wheel (e.g., red to blue)
 - **Saturation** controls color intensity (vivid vs. muted)
 - **Lightness** adjusts brightness while preserving color
 - **Colorize** replaces all colors with a single hue
 - **Layer masks** ensure the color change affects only the selected object

Practice Image

Use: `chair.jpg` from the **Task08_Recolor** folder

About this image: This photo shows a natural tan rattan chair with black metal legs against a white wall. You'll select and recolor **only the rattan/wicker seat and backrest**, changing it from the natural tan color to a completely different color while maintaining the woven texture, lighting, and shadows. The metal legs should remain black.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Open the image

1. Go to **File** → **Open**
2. Navigate to **Task08_Recolor** folder
3. Select `chair.jpg`
4. Click **Open**

Step 2: Identify what to recolor

1. **What you'll recolor:** The rattan/wicker parts of the chair (seat and backrest)
2. **What to avoid:** The black metal legs. They should stay black.

Step 3: Select the rattan parts

Method 1: Quick Selection Tool (Recommended - More Reliable)

1. Press **W** to activate the **Quick Selection Tool**
 - If you see Object Selection Tool instead, press **Shift+W** to cycle to Quick Selection
2. **Click and drag over the rattan seat area:**
 - Start by clicking on the tan rattan parts
 - Click multiple times on different areas of the rattan
 - The tool will automatically expand to similar colors
 - Continue clicking on any rattan areas not yet selected (the selection will grow automatically)
3. **If the metal legs get selected accidentally:**
 - Hold **Alt** (Windows) or **Option** (Mac)
 - Click on the black metal legs to remove them from selection
 - You'll see a minus sign (-) appear next to your cursor
4. Keep adding (click) and subtracting (Alt/Option + click) until only the rattan is selected
5. You should see **marching ants** around only the tan rattan parts, not the legs

Step 4: Refine the selection if needed

1. **Check your selection carefully:**
 - Marching ants should be around the rattan only
 - Metal legs should NOT be selected
 - If legs are selected, deselect (Ctrl+D / Cmd+D) and try again with a tighter lasso
2. If the rattan edges need refinement:
 - Click **Select and Mask** in the Options Bar
 - Use **Refine Edge Brush** (press **R**) to paint along any missed woven edges
 - Adjust **Shift Edge** by **-1 to -2%** to tighten the selection slightly
 - Click **OK** when satisfied
3. You should have clean marching ants around just the tan rattan parts

Step 5: Create Hue/Saturation adjustment layer

1. With the selection still active (marching ants visible)
2. In the **Layers panel**, click the **Adjustment Layer** icon (half-filled circle)
3. Select **Hue/Saturation**

4. **What happens:** A Hue/Saturation layer appears with a mask already created from your selection
5. The **Properties** panel opens showing Hue/Saturation controls

Step 6: Choose your recoloring method

Use this when you want to replace the rattan's natural tan color entirely with a new single color.

1. In the **Properties** panel, check the **Colorize** box at the bottom
2. **What happens:** The rattan turns a sepia/orange tone
3. Adjust the **Hue** slider:
 - Move it **left or right** to choose your new color
 - **Hue range:** 0° = red, 60° = yellow, 120° = green, 180° = cyan, 240° = blue, 300° = magenta
 - **Color suggestions for this chair:** Try blue (180-200°), emerald green (140-160°), coral (10-20°), or charcoal (any hue with low saturation)
4. Adjust **Saturation** slider:
 - Move **right** to make the color more vivid
 - **For this chair:** Try **30-45** for natural furniture looks, **50-70** for bold, modern styles
5. Adjust **Lightness** slider if needed:
 - Usually keep between **-10 to +10** to maintain original brightness
 - **For darker chairs:** Try **-15 to -20**
 - **For lighter chairs:** Try **+5 to +10**

Step 7: Fine-tune the color

2. **For realistic furniture results:**
 - Colors should look believable (avoid neon or over saturated.)
 - The woven texture should still be clearly visible
 - Shadows in the weave pattern should remain intact
3. **Toggle the layer visibility** (eye icon) to compare the original tan vs. your new color

Step 8: Refine the mask

Even with a good selection, you may need to clean up the mask edges, especially where the rattan meets the metal legs.

1. Click the **mask thumbnail** (black/white rectangle) on your Hue/Saturation layer
2. Press **B** to select the **Brush Tool**

3. Set **Opacity** to **100%** in the Options Bar

4. **Zoom in** (Ctrl/Cmd + Plus) to inspect edges, particularly where rattan meets metal

5. **To hide color from areas:**

- Make sure **black** is your foreground color (press **X** to swap if needed)
- Paint over any areas where the color spilled onto the metal legs or background

6. **To reveal color on missed areas:**

- Make sure **white** is your foreground color
- Paint over any parts of the rattan that didn't get colored

7. **For the rattan edges:**

- Use **50-70% Opacity** for softer transitions along organic edges
- Use **100% Opacity** for hard edges (like where rattan meets metal legs)

Step 9: Check realism

1. **Zoom out** to see the full chair

2. Ask yourself:

- Does the new color look like a real furniture color?
- Is the woven texture of the rattan still visible?
- Are the metal legs still black (no color bleed)?
- Do the shadows in the weave pattern still look right?
- Could this chair exist in a real furniture catalog?

3. **If something looks off:**

- Adjust the **Saturation** (lower to 30-40 for more natural furniture tones)
- Adjust the **Lightness** (± 5 to ± 10 to match the lighting)
- Refine the mask edges, especially around the metal legs

****Step 10: Export your colored chair 4. File → Export → Export As**

- Format: **JPG**, Quality: **90%**
- Name: Task08_After_FirstName_LastName.jpg
- Click **Export**

Step 12: Save final PSD

1. **File** → **Save** (or Ctrl/Cmd + S)
2. Make sure it's saved as: Task08_Recolor_FirstName_LastName.psd
3. This preserves all your adjustment layers and masks for future edits

Deliverables

Save in your **Task08_Recolor** folder:

- Task08_Recolor_FirstName_LastName.psd (PSD file with adjustment layer and mask)
- Task08_After_FirstName_LastName.jpg (recolored version)

Tips

- 💡 **Colorize for solid furniture colors** (like a blue chair or emerald chair), **Hue shift to preserve texture** (keeps the woven pattern more pronounced)
- 💡 Keep **Saturation 30-45** for natural furniture tones, or **50-70** for bold modern furniture, avoid over saturation
- 💡 **For this chair:** Make sure the metal legs stay black—zoom in and check for color bleed
- 💡 **For this chair:** The woven texture should remain visible in your final result
- 💡 Use a **hard brush at 100% opacity** when masking along the metal legs (hard edges required)
- 💡 Use a **soft brush at 50-70% opacity** when masking along organic rattan edges
- 💡 **Furniture colors should look realistic**—think catalog, not cartoon
- 💡 Create **multiple color variations** (blue vs. emerald vs. coral) to compare options
- 💡 **Press X** to quickly swap between black and white while painting masks

Grading Criteria (5 pts)

Criterion	Points
Object accurately selected with clean edges and realistic color change applied	2
Hue/Saturation settings produce natural-looking results (not over saturated or unrealistic)	2
Layer mask properly refined with no color spill or harsh edges	1

Task 9: Compositing with Shadows (5 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn how to create realistic photo composites by placing objects into new backgrounds with proper shadows and lighting integration. This technique is essential for creative photography, digital art, and product visualization where you need to seamlessly blend elements from different photos.

What You'll Learn

- Placing and transforming objects in new scenes
- Creating drop shadows (contact shadows)
- Creating cast shadows (projected shadows)
- Blurring and adjusting opacity for photorealism

Background & Resources

Before starting, understand compositing:

- **Adobe's Official Guide:** [Composite Images](#)
- **Video Tutorial:** Search YouTube for "Photoshop Compositing with Realistic Shadows"
- **Key Concepts:**
 - **Drop shadow** is the dark area directly under/touching an object
 - **Cast shadow** is projected away from the object based on light direction
 - **Perspective** determines shadow angle and size
 - Shadows should match the **lighting direction** in the background scene
 - Softer blur = higher/farther light source; sharper = closer light

Practice Images

Use:

- `street_scene.jpg` from **Task09_Compositing** folder (background destination)
- `walking_dog.png` from **Task09_Compositing** folder (man walking dog silhouette)

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Open the background scene

1. Go to **File** → **Open**
2. Navigate to **Task09_Compositing** folder
3. Select `street_scene.jpg`
4. Click **Open**
5. **Study the lighting:** Notice the sun is coming from the upper-left (you can see lens flare). Existing shadows go toward the lower right.

Step 2: Place the object

1. Go to **File** → **Place Embedded**
2. Navigate to **Task09_Compositing** folder
3. Select `walking_dog.png`
4. Click **Place**
5. The man and dog appear with a transform bounding box

Step 3: Scale and position the object

1. The object is in **Free Transform** mode automatically
2. Hold **Shift** and drag a corner handle to **resize proportionally**
3. **Scale the person to realistic size:**
4. **Drag from the center** to move the silhouette onto the brick paver area
 - Good placement: On the lit area of pavers where shadows are visible
 - Avoid placing in the dark shadowed areas where your shadows won't show well
5. Press **Enter** to confirm the placement

Step 4: Adjust perspective if needed

1. **For this silhouette:** You likely don't need perspective adjustment since it's a side view
2. However, if you want to experiment:
 - Press **Ctrl+T** (Windows) or **Cmd+T** (Mac) for Free Transform
 - Right click and select **Skew** or **Distort**
 - Adjust slightly if the person seems to float or not match the ground plane
 - Press **Enter**
3. Keep adjustments subtle for realism

Step 5: Create a new layer for drop shadow

1. In **Layers panel**, click **New Layer** icon
2. Rename it: `Drop Shadow`
3. **Drag this layer below** your object layer

4. Drop shadow should be behind the object

Step 6: Paint the drop shadow

1. Select the **Drop Shadow** layer
2. Press **B** for Brush Tool
3. Set **Foreground color to Black**
4. Choose a **soft round brush**
5. Set **Opacity** to **30-50%** in Options Bar
6. **Paint directly under the person's feet and the dog's paws** where they touch the brick pavers
7. **For this silhouette:**
 - Create a small shadow under **each foot** (two contact points)
 - Create a small shadow under the **dog's paws** (four smaller contact points)
 - Make shadows **darkest** at contact points
 - Keep them **small and tight**, just where feet/paws meet ground
 - Make them **fairly sharp** (strong sun in this scene)
8. Build up gradually with multiple light strokes

Step 7: Create cast shadow layer

1. Create another **New Layer**
2. Rename it: **Cast Shadow**
3. Place it **below the object** but **above Drop Shadow**

Step 8: Create cast shadow shape

Before painting, understand the shadow direction:

1. **Study the existing shadows in the street scene:**
 - Look at the **bollards** (the short posts) and see their shadows?
 - Those shadows stretch toward the **lower right corner** of the image
 - The sun is **behind** the bollards (upper left), so shadows go the opposite way
 - Your person and dog shadows must go the **same direction** as the bollard shadows
2. **Select the **Cast Shadow** layer** (make sure it's highlighted in the Layers panel)
3. **Set up your Brush Tool:**

- Press **B** for Brush Tool
- Foreground color should be **Black** (press D to reset colors if needed)
- In the **Options Bar** at top, set **Opacity** to **50-60%**
- Choose a **soft round brush** (use [or] keys to adjust size)

4. Paint the person's cast shadow:

- Start at the **person's feet**
- Paint a long brushstroke going toward the **lower right**
- The shadow should follow the **shape of the person** (head, shoulders, coat, legs)
- Make it approximately as long as the person is tall (or slightly longer)
- Use multiple strokes to build up the shadow shape

5. Paint the dog's cast shadow:

- Start at the **dog's body**
- Paint toward the **lower right** (same direction!)
- The dog's shadow will be **shorter** than the person's shadow (because the dog is lower to the ground)
- Follow the shape of the dog's body and legs

6. Check your work:

- Does your shadow go toward the lower right like the bollard shadows?
- Is the person's shadow longer than the dog's shadow?
- Does it look like the sun is behind them (upper left)?

Step 9: Blur the cast shadow

1. Make sure **Cast Shadow** layer is selected
2. Go to **Filter → Blur → Gaussian Blur**
3. **For this scene:** Use **Radius 8-15 pixels**
 - This scene has fairly sharp shadows (strong sun)
 - Don't over blur. The bollard shadows are quite defined
 - Match the sharpness you see in the existing shadows
4. Click **OK**

Step 10: Adjust shadow opacity

1. Select the **Cast Shadow** layer
2. In **Layers panel**, adjust the **Opacity** slider to **50-70%**

- **For this scene:** The strong backlight creates fairly dark, distinct shadows
 - Match the darkness of the bollard shadows in the scene (around 60-70%)
3. The shadow should be visible but not pure black

Step 11: Refine drop shadow

1. Select the `Drop Shadow` layer
2. You can also apply **Gaussian Blur** (Filter → Blur → Gaussian Blur)
 - **For this scene:** Use small radius (**3-6 pixels**) for fairly sharp drop shadow
 - Match the sharpness of contact shadows you see on the bollards
3. Adjust **Opacity** to **60-70%**
4. Drop shadows in strong sun are darker and sharper

Step 12: Check realism

1. **Zoom out** to view the entire composite
2. **Compare with the bollard shadows:**
 - Does your shadow point toward the lower right like theirs?
 - Is your shadow the same sharpness as the bollard shadows?
 - Is your shadow the same darkness (around 60-70% opacity)?
3. Check:
 - Does the object's size make sense for the street scene?
 - Does the object look like it's standing on the brick pavers?
 - Does overall lighting match the backlighting?
4. Make final adjustments to shadows or object placement

Step 15: Save and export

1. **File → Save As**
 - Format: **Photoshop (*.PSD)**
 - Name: `Task09_Compositing_FirstName_LastName.psd`
2. **File → Export → Export As**
 - Format: **JPG**, Quality: **90%**
 - Name: `Task09_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg`

Deliverables

Save in your **Task09_Compositing** folder:

- Task09_Compositing_FirstName_LastName.psd (with all layers: object, drop shadow, cast shadow)
- Task09_Final_FirstName_LastName.jpg (final composite image)

Tips

💡 **Study the bollard shadows first** they show you exactly the direction, sharpness, and darkness your shadows need

💡 **Shadow direction is critical** light from upper-left means shadows go toward lower-right (match the bollards!)

💡 **Two shadow types:** Drop shadows are dark and tight under feet/paws; cast shadows are softer and stretch away

💡 **Build gradually** use low opacity (30-50%) and multiple brush strokes; shadows that are too dark look fake

Grading Criteria (5 pts)

Criterion	Points
Object properly scaled, positioned, and integrated into scene with correct perspective	2
Realistic drop shadow created at contact point with appropriate darkness and softness	1
Realistic cast shadow that matches lighting direction and intensity of the scene	2

Task 10: Generative AI in Photoshop (10 Points)

▼ 🖱️ Click to expand the step by step guide

Objective

In this task, you will learn how to use Photoshop's Generative AI tools responsibly to create and edit images using text prompts and reference images. This cutting-edge technology allows you to generate entirely new images, remove or add objects, and maintain consistent styles - all while working non-destructively.

 **Important Note:** Photoshop's Generative AI features have limited credits per month. Use them appropriately and avoid unnecessary generations. If you run out of credits before completing this task, please contact your teacher immediately.

What You'll Learn

- Generating complete images from text descriptions
- Editing photos with Generative Fill (add/remove objects)
- Using reference images to guide AI output
- Understanding Generative Layers and non-destructive workflow
- Following ethical guidelines for AI-generated content
- Taking screenshots to document your generative process

Background & Resources

Before starting, review these official Adobe guides:

Required Adobe Learning Resources:

1. Generate Images Using Text Prompts

-  [Generate images with descriptive text prompts](#)
- Learn how Photoshop converts written prompts into entirely new images

2. Edit Images Using Generative Fill

-  [Edit images with Generative Fill](#)
- Learn to add, remove, or modify parts of existing images using AI

3. Generate Using a Reference Image

-  [Use reference images for consistent results](#)
- Guide AI results by uploading reference images for style matching

Key Concepts:

- **Generative Layers** are non-destructive - you can regenerate or modify them anytime
- **Generate Image** creates entirely new images from text descriptions
- **Generative Fill** modifies selected areas of existing photos
- **Reference Images** help maintain consistent style, color, or composition

Ethical Guidelines (IMPORTANT - READ BEFORE STARTING)

⚠️ You **MUST** follow these rules:

- ❌ NO fake faces of celebrities or real, identifiable people
- ❌ NO deepfakes or misleading political/public figure imagery
- ❌ NO harmful, violent, hateful, or inappropriate content
- ❌ NO copyrighted characters or trademarked brands
- ✅ YES to creative scenes - landscapes, objects, abstract compositions
- ✅ YES to realistic prompts - keep results believable and appropriate
- 🗣️ Disclose AI use if sharing images publicly

Violation of these guidelines will result in zero points for this task.

✅ Part A: Generate an Image from Prompt

Create a completely new image from scratch using only a text description.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Create a new document with Generate Image

1. Open Photoshop
2. Go to **File** → **New** (or Ctrl/Cmd + N)
3. In the **New Document** dialog, you'll see a **Generate Image** button just below the document.
4. Click **Generate Image** button
5. A new interface opens with a text prompt box

Step 2: Write your prompt

1. In the **text prompt box**, type a clear, descriptive prompt
2. **Be specific but concise** that is you will describe what you want to create

Good prompt examples:

- modern workspace with natural window light
- quiet park pathway in autumn with fallen leaves
- minimalist living room interior with plants
- coastal beach scene at sunset
- cozy coffee shop interior with wooden tables

Avoid:

- ❌ Names of real people or celebrities
- ❌ Copyrighted characters (Mickey Mouse, Superman, etc.)
- ❌ Violent or inappropriate scenes
- ❌ Overly complex descriptions

3. Click **Generate** button

Step 3: Review generated variations

1. Wait 15-30 seconds for generation
2. Photoshop creates **3 variations** and displays them:
 - You'll see 3 thumbnail images to choose from
 - Look for the most realistic result
 - Check for weird artifacts or distortions
3. **Click on your preferred variation** Clicking it will select that one
4. The selected variation becomes your active image

Step 4: Accept the image

1. Your selected variation is now open in Photoshop
2. You'll see it in the canvas with a Generative Layer
3. If you want to try a different variation:
 - Go back and repeat Step 2-3 with the same or modified prompt
4. When satisfied with your choice, proceed to save.

Step 5: Save your generated image

1. Go to **File** → **Save As**
2. Navigate to **Task10_Generative** folder
3. **Format:** JPEG
4. **Name:** Task10_Generate_FirstName_LastName.jpg
5. **Quality:** 90%
6. Click **Save**

Step 6: Take screenshot of Generative Layer

1. Look at your **Layers panel**
2. You should see a layer with a **purple sparkle icon** (Generative Layer)
3. Take a screenshot showing:

- The Layers panel with the Generative Layer visible
 - The purple sparkle icon that identifies it as AI-generated
4. Save as: Task10_PartA_Layers_FirstName_LastName.png

Part B: Edit Image Using Generative Fill

Use Generative Fill to modify an existing photo by removing and adding objects.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Choose your base image

1. Select an image to edit:
 - Use an image from your previous tasks (street scene, chair, etc.)
 - Or download a free stock photo from [Unsplash](#) or [Pexels](#)
2. Go to **File** → **Open**
3. Select your chosen image
4. Click **Open**

Step 2: Duplicate background layer

1. In **Layers panel**, right-click the **Background** layer
2. Select **Duplicate Layer**
3. Click **OK**
4. This protects your original image

Step 3: Remove an object

Remove an unwanted element from your photo.

1. Select an appropriate selection tool:
 - **Object Selection Tool** (W) It is best for distinct objects.
 - **Lasso Tool** (L) It is best for manual selection
 - **Quick Selection Tool** (W) It is bestw for similar colors
2. **Select the object you want to remove:**
 - Completely encompass the unwanted object
 - Include a small margin around it (5-10 pixels)
 - Examples: trash can, person, sign, power lines, blemish depending on your image
3. The **Contextual Task Bar** appears at the bottom of the screen

4. Click the **Generative Fill** button in the Task Bar
5. **Leave the text prompt EMPTY** This tells AI to remove and match the background
6. Click **Generate**
7. Wait 15-30 seconds for processing
8. **Review all 3 variations** in the Properties panel (click thumbnails to switch)
9. Select the cleanest removal

Step 4: Add a new object

Add a creative element to your photo.

1. Use a selection tool to select **where you want the new object**:
 - **Rectangular Marquee Tool** (M) for defined areas
 - **Lasso Tool** (L) for custom shapes
 - Select an appropriate-sized area (not too large)
2. The **Contextual Task Bar** appears
3. Click in the **Generative Fill text prompt box**
4. **Type a clear, simple prompt** describing what you want to add:

Good prompts:

- small yellow flower
- wooden bench
- red bicycle
- stone pathway
- green plant in pot

Avoid:

- ❌ Complex multi-object scenes
- ❌ Specific people or celebrities
- ❌ Trademarked characters or logos

5. Click **Generate**
6. Wait for processing
7. **Review all 3 variations**. Choose the most realistic and well integrated option

Step 5: Clean up with Remove Tool or masks

Polish any AI artifacts or unnatural edges.

1. Select the **Remove Tool**:
 - Find it in the toolbar (may be grouped with Spot Healing Brush)
 - Or press **Shift + J** to cycle through healing tools
2. **Brush over any imperfections**:
 - Blurry spots or glitches
 - Harsh edges where AI content meets original photo
 - Color mismatches
3. Use small brush strokes for precision

Step 6: Save your edited image

1. **File** → **Export** → **Quick Export as PNG**
2. Navigate to **Task10_Generative** folder
3. **Name**: `Task10_Fill_Edit_FirstName_LastName.png`
4. Click **Save**

Step 7: Take screenshot of Generative Fill layers

1. Look at **Layers panel**
2. It should show:
 - Multiple Generative Fill layers with purple sparkle icons
 - Original background layer
3. Take a screenshot of the Layers panel
4. Save as: `Task10_PartB_Layers_FirstName_LastName.png`

Part C: Generate Using Reference Image

Use a reference image to guide AI generation for consistent style or appearance.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Prepare your base image

1. Open the image you want to modify (can be the same as Part B)
2. Or open a new image to work with
3. **File** → **Open** and select your image

Step 2: Make a selection

1. Use a selection tool (**Lasso, Marquee, Quick Selection**)
2. Select an area where you want to generate content
3. Choose a meaningful area (not too small, not entire canvas)

Step 3: Access Generative Fill with Reference Image

1. With your selection active, the **Contextual Task Bar** appears
2. Click **Generative Fill** button
3. In the Generative Fill panel/box, look for **Reference Image** option:
 - You may see a small image icon or "Add Reference" button

Step 4: Upload reference image

1. Click the **Reference Image** button/icon
2. **Choose Reference Image** dialog opens
3. Navigate to an image you want to use as style/content reference
4. Examples:
 - Use a photo of a specific object style
 - Use an image with colors you want to match
 - Use a composition you want AI to emulate
5. Select your reference image file
6. Click **Open**

Step 5: Write your prompt (optional)

1. You can combine reference images with text prompts
2. Type a brief description if needed
3. Or leave empty to let the reference guide the generation

Step 6: Generate with reference

1. Click **Generate**
2. Wait for processing (may take slightly longer with reference images)
3. AI will create variations influenced by your reference image:
 - Style consistency
 - Color palette matching
 - Object appearance similarity

Step 7: Review and select

1. Review all 3 generated variations

2. Compare how well they match your reference image's style
3. Select the best result

Step 8: Save your reference-guided image

1. **File** → **Save As**
2. Navigate to **Task10_Generative** folder
3. **Format:** JPEG
4. **Name:** Task10_Reference_FirstName_LastName.jpg
5. **Quality:** 90%
6. Click **Save**

Step 9: Take screenshot showing reference image

1. When Generative Fill panel/Properties shows the reference image thumbnail, take a screenshot showing:
 - The reference image thumbnail in the interface
 - The Generative Layer result
 - The original selection area
2. Save as: Task10_PartC_Reference_FirstName_LastName.png



Deliverables

Save ALL files in your **Task10_Generative** folder:

Final Images (3 required):

- Task10_Generate_FirstName_LastName.png (Part A: generated image from prompt)
- Task10_Fill_Edit_FirstName_LastName.png (Part B: image with removed and added objects)
- Task10_Reference_FirstName_LastName.jpg (Part C: generation using reference image)

Screenshots (3 required):

- Task10_PartA_Layers_FirstName_LastName.png (Layers panel showing Generative Layer from Part A)
- Task10_PartB_Layers_FirstName_LastName.png (Layers panel showing multiple Generative Fill layers from Part B)

- Task10_PartC_Reference_FirstName_LastName.png (Screenshot showing reference image in interface)

Tips

- 💡 **Simple prompts work best** 💡 **Always review all 3 variations** - the first generation isn't always the best option
- 💡 **Empty prompts for removal** - leave blank when removing objects; AI matches surroundings automatically
- 💡 **Reference images are powerful** - use them to maintain consistent style across multiple generations

Grading Criteria (10 pts)

Criterion	Points
Part A: Successfully generated image from prompt with appropriate content and screenshot of Generative Layer	3
Part B: Object removal and addition with Generative Fill are seamless and realistic	3
Part C: Reference image used effectively to guide generation with screenshot documentation	3
Ethics: All ethical guidelines followed; all required screenshots provided	1

Congratulations!

You have now completed all photo editing tasks ! I hope you enjoyed the tasks.

Keep practicing.

Well done! 🌟